

and now its Moto E, in all probability, has already overtaken the G in terms of the number of units sold.

If you use any of the three latest Motorola smartphones, you will be aware that the company doesn't simply put in pure Android into its devices. Motorola has been bringing out its own apps based on what its customers want. With the Moto X and Moto G, the company had showcased the Motorola Assist app, which recognises what you are doing and sets up your phone accordingly. This includes a driving mode that reads your text messages or plays music automatically, a feature that allows only important calls after working hours, and so on. Although Assist has been downloaded by over 5 million users, it still has some issues that the company needs to iron out.

Apps that matter

At the launch event for the Moto E, the company showcased another of its apps—the Moto Alert app, which provides emergency services. This app lets you periodically notify your near and dear ones of your whereabouts to enable them to help you if necessary. You can set your locations as 'home', 'work', 'school', etc. In addition, the app also lets you trigger an alarm or automatically call your emergency contacts. You can also press the lock button five times to trigger an alarm on your phone. This app has received quite a few positive reviews from users.

Previously owned by Google, Motorola has been sold to Chinese PC giant Lenovo, recently. The complete

While the company is considering the option of going open, it doesn't think that this is the right time to do so. Soni did not, however, rule out the possibility of Motorola launching its own open source initiatives in the future.

process of acquisition should be over by the end of the year. Motorola, though, has been on a mission to regain its share in the smartphone market. The company has repeatedly talked about how important the Indian market is for it, and with both the Moto G and Moto E doing well, this has been a good start for the firm.

While it is still setting up its business in the country, the current partnership with Flipkart seems to be working well for Motorola. Soni said that Motorola's focus right now is to set up its base in India, and the makers of the first mobile phone seem to be doing that well. This was also confirmed by Magnus Ahlqvist, corporate vice president for EMEA and APAC, Motorola.

Whether Motorola will have open source initiatives for its smartphones in the future remains to be seen. But like we said earlier, there's a good chance that it will. Soni did not rule out the possibility but the company is understandably focusing more on rebuilding its base in India rather than on developer initiatives. Pure Android is working for the firm at the moment. The Moto Assist and Moto Alert apps may lead to a lot more. 

Continued from page 93...

Since open source is no more an alien phenomenon, the level of acceptance is far greater than what it may have been ten years ago. Bagchi says, "I think, today, almost everyone understands and acknowledges the advantages that open source technology brings with it. There is enough awareness, so we don't have those issues coming our way so frequently. However, if any of our clients are not aware of the benefits offered by open source, we explain them at length, to propagate our product and philosophy. Some of the clients do raise questions on licensing issues, and we help them by providing licensing details in the Service Legal Agreement and End User Licence Agreement when we work with them. Also, since we sell products based on open source frameworks, rather than the open source frameworks themselves, things are not so challenging for us."

For many operating in the open source space, getting the right kind of talent can be quite a task. But things are radically different for Sparsha. Bagchi claims that getting the right kind of talent was never a struggle for him. "In fact, due to the fact that we use open source technologies, it's much easier to get the right talent. Today, enterprising, young, talented men and women work and create their portfolio using open source technologies. They write blogs, etc; so, it's much easier to locate and get them on board."

Tip for open source businesses

Today, there are a number of 'marketplaces' for known open source technologies, where a developer can make money. For example, if you are great at Twitter Bootstrap, then there are awesome marketplaces online where you can advertise and market your bootstrap themes, and have the right audience buy them. Developers have made tens of thousands of dollars in these marketplaces.

"With open source technologies, one gets the convenience of easier on-premise deployments. Also, since there are no licensing restrictions involved, life gets a whole lot easier."

The company chooses some innovative ways of reaching out to the desired candidates prior to hiring. Bagchi elaborates, "We organise coding hackathons and contests using our tool Coderipe (www.coderipe.com), and select those who do well for the face-to-face interviews. In some cases, we have taken the help of recruitment agencies as well." Sparsha goes in for both lateral and fresh hiring. For R&D work, it primarily chooses freshers. For senior management roles, the firm does lateral hiring. 